

Plant Systems — How Water and Food Move

Name: _____ Date: _____

To the adult helping: Read every part of this page aloud with the student, including the word banks. The student can say an answer, point to it, or write it — any of these is fine.

I can find the parts of a plant and show how water and food move through it.

A plant has two systems. The **root system** is below the ground. The **shoot system** is above the ground. Water moves up through the plant. Food moves down through the plant.

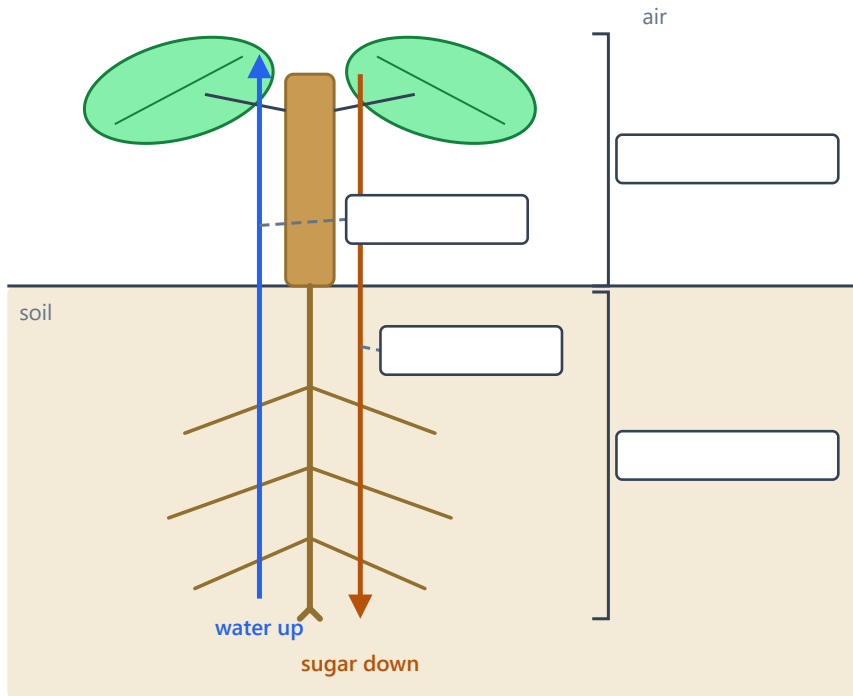
WORD BANK

root system

shoot system

xylem

phloem



WORD TO KNOW

Root system — all the roots of a plant. It is under the ground.

WORD TO KNOW

Shoot system — the stem and leaves. It is above the ground.

WORD TO KNOW

Xylem — the tube that carries water up the plant.

WORD TO KNOW

Phloem — the tube that carries sugar (food) down the plant.

Root System does:

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

Shoot System does:

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

WATCH OUT

Many people think roots take in food. Roots take in water and minerals. The plant makes its own food in its leaves.

WORD BANK

absorbs water and minerals

holds the plant in the soil

stores food

holds leaves up to the light

makes food (photosynthesis)

makes new plants

CHECK YOURSELF

Does water move up or down the xylem? Say your answer out loud.

Xylem and Phloem — What Each One Carries

Tissue	What it carries	Which way it goes
Xylem	_____	_____
Phloem	_____	_____

WORD BANK

- water and minerals
- sugar (food)
- up, from roots to leaves
- down, from leaves to the rest of the plant

One part I'm still not sure about:
